THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 10 ENGLISH — READING SKILL PAPER SET 02

Reading Comprehension | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 45 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 20**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A has one discursive passage with 10 questions (1 mark each).
3. Section B has one case-based passage with 10 questions (1 mark each).
4. Questions include MCQs and short answers of 30–40 words.
5. Write the question number before each answer.

SECTION — A (Reading Comprehension: Discursive Passage, 400–450 words) 10 Marks

Read the passage and answer the questions.

1. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

Ask a group of students what they would like to have more of and a large number will say, without a moment's hesitation, 'sleep'. It is odd, then, that the thing we all crave is the first thing we sacrifice when examinations come near. We stay awake with books and tea, believing that every extra hour of study is a gift to our future. Doctors and teachers who have watched this habit for years tell a different story.

During sleep the brain is not idle. It sorts the day's experiences, throws out what is useless and stores what is useful. A lesson revised at ten at night and then slept upon is often remembered better than a lesson read at three in the morning. A tired brain also makes careless mistakes: a student who has not slept may know the formula perfectly and still copy a number wrongly. In this way, the hours saved by staying awake are quietly taken back in the examination hall.

Research from sleep laboratories supports their view. When volunteers were allowed only five hours of rest for a week, they made more errors in simple sums, forgot instructions and grew irritable over small matters. Those who slept for eight hours were quicker, calmer and more creative in solving problems. The brain, it seems, does not merely rest at night; it files the day's learning, discards what is unimportant and prepares the pathways for tomorrow. A student who sits up all night before an examination, therefore, may know more facts at midnight but remember fewer of them at ten in the morning. Sleep experts add that the habit can be corrected gently: shifting bedtime by fifteen minutes every few days is easier than a sudden change, and a hot bath or a short walk in the evening helps the body to wind down.

Sleep also guards our mood. A child who sleeps less than seven or eight hours is more likely to be irritable, to quarrel with friends and to lose interest in things that were once enjoyable. Parents often scold such children for 'attitude' when what they need is a longer night.

Good sleep needs a little discipline. The room should be dark and cool, and bright screens should be put away at least half an hour before bedtime. Heavy meals and strong tea late in the evening make rest difficult. Above all, there should be a fixed hour for going to bed, even on holidays. A body that knows when to expect sleep is generous in giving it.

(i) Why does the writer find it odd that students lose sleep before examinations? 1

(a) They dislike study **(b)** They never feel sleepy

(c) They give up what they most want to have **(d)** They fall ill

(ii) During sleep the brain: 1

(a) stops working **(b)** repeats lessons aloud

(c) sorts and stores the day's experiences **(d)** forgets everything

(iii) A student who has not slept may: 1

(a) remember better **(b)** copy a number wrongly though he knows the formula

(c) score full marks **(d)** finish early

(iv) Children who sleep less than seven or eight hours are likely to be: 1

(a) silent **(b)** irritable **(c)** athletic **(d)** cheerful

(v) Which of the following is NOT advised for good sleep? 1

(a) A fixed bedtime **(b)** Drinking strong tea in the evening

(c) A dark, cool room **(d)** Putting screens away early

(vi) What do students sacrifice first as examinations come near? 1

(vii) How is a lesson revised at ten at night better than one at three in the morning? 1

(viii) Why do parents wrongly scold sleepy children? 1

(ix) Find a word in the passage which means 'to want very strongly'. 1

(x) Find a word in the passage which is the opposite of 'careful'. 1

SECTION — B (Reading Comprehension: Case-based Passage with data/visual input, 200–250 words) 10 Marks

Read the text and answer the questions.

2. *Read the following case and answer the questions that follow.* 10

The Health Club of the school was worried about the late-night habits of the senior students. For a fortnight, its members distributed slips on which students noted the time they went to bed and woke up. The club also obtained the marks of the same students in the pre-board test from the examination branch, with the permission of the Principal, and the names were removed to protect privacy.

A health club surveyed 100 students of Class 10 about the number of hours they slept on a school night, and noted the average marks of each group in the pre-board test.

Hours of sleep	Number of students	Average marks (out of 80)
Less than 5	12	46
5 to 6	28	52
7 to 8	45	63
More than 8	15	60

The club's convener cautioned that a table of this kind shows a pattern, not a rule. Other factors, such as the quality of teaching and the effort put in by each student, also affect marks. Even so, the club decided to hold a talk by a paediatrician on healthy routines, and to request the school to avoid scheduling tests on the day after a major festival. The Principal added that parents would be informed about the findings through the school diary, and that students who wish to discuss their routine in private may meet the school counsellor on Tuesdays.

(i) How many students slept for 7 to 8 hours? 1

(a) 12 **(b)** 15 **(c)** 45 **(d)** 28

(ii) Which group scored the highest average marks? 1

(a) 7 to 8 hours **(b)** More than 8 hours

(c) 5 to 6 hours **(d)** Less than 5 hours

(iii) How many students slept for 6 hours or less (including the 5–6 group and below)? 1

(a) 55 **(b)** 28 **(c)** 12 **(d)** 40

(iv) What was the average score of students who slept less than 5 hours? 1

(v) How much higher is the best average than the lowest average? 1

(vi) What percentage of the students slept for 7 to 8 hours? 1

(vii) Do the figures prove that more sleep always gives higher marks? Give a reason. 1

(viii) Suggest one conclusion from the table. 1

(ix) Name the group that scored lower than 50. 1

(x) Find a word in the passage which means 'a study of a group'. 1

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 20 Marks**

MASTERMIND